

Seminary Lesson

May 15, 2026

Joshua 1 – Lesson 61

"The Lord Will Not Fail Us or Forsake Us"

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Welcome to Seminary

Today's focus

- **Scripture:** Joshua 1:1-9
- **Purpose:** Draw strength from the Lord's promises
- **Big idea:** The same God who promised Joshua "I will not fail thee" makes that same promise to us

Class structure (40 min)

1. **Opening prayer** (2 min)
2. **QT Time** (10 min) – Student Name
3. **Lesson** (15 min) – Joshua 1
4. **Discussion & application** (10 min)
5. **Closing** (3 min)

Opening activities

Opening prayer

Ask someone to offer the opening prayer.

QT Time

Student Name is leading QT Time this week.

Question: *Add the student's discussion question before class*

Flow: Small groups → discuss → come back together → **one** person per group shares a **short** highlight (1-2 sentences).

What scares you right now?

Think about something hard you're facing – a test, a relationship, a decision, a change you didn't ask for.

What does "courage" look like in that situation?

Hold that in mind. Joshua was about to face something far scarier – and God had something to say about it.

A name worth knowing

Joshua's name is the same as Jesus.

In Hebrew, Joshua is *Yehoshua* – "the Lord saves." In Greek, that becomes *Iesous* – Jesus. Both names carry the same meaning: **God is our salvation.**

Why it matters: When the Lord says "I will be with thee" to Joshua, He's making a promise that the Savior would later embody in person. Joshua leading Israel into the promised land is a *similitude* – a type pointing forward to Christ leading us home.

Joshua 1:1-4 – A new leader, a huge task

Moses has just died. The Lord calls Joshua to lead Israel across the Jordan River and into Canaan:

"Moses my servant is dead; now therefore arise, go over this Jordan, thou, and all this people, unto the land which I do give to them."

Think about it: Moses was a towering figure – miracles, the Law, forty years of leadership. What would it feel like to step into his shoes? What would Joshua need most right now?

Joshua 1:5-9 – What God promises

"There shall not any man be able to stand before thee all the days of thy life... I will not fail thee, nor forsake thee. Be strong and courageous... for the Lord thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest."

Count the commands: How many times does God say "be strong" or "be courageous" in these verses? Why do you think He repeats it?

Joshua 1:8 – The condition

"This book of the law shall not depart out of thy mouth; but thou shalt meditate therein day and night, that thou mayest observe to do according to all that is written therein: for then thou shalt make thy way prosperous, and then thou shalt have good success."

Notice the structure: The promise of success is connected to something specific. What does the Lord tell Joshua to do – and how is it different from just *reading* the scriptures?

Going deeper

Option A – What courage actually is

Courage isn't the absence of fear – it's acting *despite* fear because you trust something bigger.

Read any three of these:

- Deuteronomy 31:7-8
- Isaiah 40:29-31
- John 14:27
- Romans 8:31
- 2 Timothy 1:7

In your notebook: Name a challenge you're currently facing. What does "strong and courageous" look like for *you* in that situation? What do you know about God that makes courage possible?

Option B – Meditating on scripture

Elder D. Todd Christofferson on what it means to *study* rather than just read:

"When I say 'study,' I mean something more than reading... You should care more about the amount of time you spend in the scriptures than about the amount you read in that time." – Ensign, May 2004, 11

Try it now: Choose one verse from Joshua 1:5-9. Spend 3-4 minutes with it:

1. Read it slowly – more than once
2. Ask: *What does this tell me about God? What does He want me to do or feel?*
3. Write one insight in your notebook

Then share: What made it easier or harder to really *slow down* with a verse?

Discussion

1. **God told Joshua to "be strong and courageous" three times in nine verses.** Why do you think He repeated it? What does that tell you about how God views fear?
2. **Joshua 1:8 ties success to meditating on scripture day and night.** What's the difference between reading the scriptures and really *meditating* on them? Have you ever experienced that difference?
3. **"The Lord thy God is with thee whithersoever thou goest."** Where in your life do you most need to believe that right now?

This week

Challenge

- Identify **one thing** you've been putting off because it feels too hard or too scary.
- Read Joshua 1:9 before you take your first step toward it.

Personal reflection

- Write in your notebook: *"The Lord said 'I will not fail thee' to Joshua. I believe He says the same thing to me when _____."*
- Try Option B's meditation method with one verse this week – just once, slowly.

Closing Closing Prayer

Ask someone to offer the closing prayer.